

Prefixes and suffixes

Prefixes	Meanings	Examples
aero-	air	aerodynamic, aerosol
agri-	of earth (relating to soil)	agribusiness, agriculturalist
ambi-	both	ambiguous, ambivalent
astro-	star	astrology, astronaut
bio-	life, living things	biodiversity, biofuel
contra-	against, opposite	contraband, contradict
deca-	ten	decade, decahedron
di-, du-, duo-	two	dioxide, duet, duotone
electro-	relating to electricity	electrolysis, electromagnet
geo-	relating to Earth	geography, geology
hydro-	relating to water	hydroelectricity, hydropower
infra-	below, beneath	infrared, infrastructure
kilo-	one thousand	kilogram, kilometer
mal-	bad	malaise, malnourished
maxi-	large	maximize, maximum
multi-	many	multicultural, multiply
nano-	one-billionth, extremely small	nanosecond, nanotechnology
ped-	foot	pedestrian, pedometer
proto-	first	protocol, prototype
sy-, syl-, sym-, syn-	together, with	system, syllable, symbol, synthesis
tele-	distant	telephone, telescope

Suffixes	Meaning	Examples
-ade	action	blockade, masquerade
-an	person, belonging to	guardian, historian
-ancy, -ency	state	vacancy, agency
-ar, -ary	resembling	linear, exemplary
-ard, -art	characterize	wizard, braggart
-ence, -ency	state	dependence, emergency
-ess	female	lioness, waitress
-fy	to make into	beautify, simplify
-iatry	healing, medical care	podiatry, psychiatry
-ile	having the qualities of	projectile, senile
-or, -our	condition	humor, glamour
-ory	having the function of	compulsory, contributory
-phobia	fear of	agoraphobia, arachnophobia
-ure	action	exposure, measure
-wise	in the manner of	clockwise, likewise